headed by Mirza, who was once considered close to the Afghan government. This was an unexpected development and in late 1990, an Indian intelligence operative was sent to develop contact with Abdul Jaleel, a commander of Hizb-e-Wahdat Island Afghanistan, which had excellent influence over the Tajik and Hazara communities. Jaleel was paid a handsome amount and the R&AW later used his network for operations in Tajikistan and Iran. But among all the warlords in the network of Indian agents, Massoud, despite meagre support, was the most reliable and extremely powerful.

'He always wanted to attack from the front. I cautioned him about the increasing casualties among his forces and he smiled and said, "Ved sahib, we are born to fight, don't worry about the casualties. We are going to rule Afghanistan soon,"' Ved Asthana recalled.

After the dissolution of the Soviet Union on 26 December 1991 and the subsequent decision of the Russian government to stop the aid to Afghanistan, Najibullah was left to fend for himself. In March 1992 he offered to resign and in April he quit. Later he was forced to take refuge at the UN office in Kabul.

The Afghan Justice Project, which prepared a report on Afghan war crimes, said that within a few months of the collapse of Najibul-lah's government, Kabul was engulfed in a civil war. During this conflict, the multiple factions that had participated in the struggle against Najibullah's regime and the Soviet occupation fought together with various militias for control of territory within and around the capital, as well as elsewhere in the country. Despite intermittent efforts by the United Nations, it proved impossible to win sufficient support for any political agreement on power sharing for the sake of stability. Following